

GA-OP-01

Privacy & Confidentiality

Responsible collection, use, storage, and sharing of information about students, families, and colleagues.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Employment Contract clause 12

01 Policy statement

Confidential information is shared only for a legitimate school purpose and only with people who need it to carry out their role. Privacy supports dignity, trust, and safeguarding.

02 Protected information

Confidential information includes:

- School, learner, parent, or guardian financial information.
- Academic records, assessments, and personal information of learners and families.
- Internal school matters, policies, incidents, or disputes that could bring the school into disrepute.
- Private human-resources information, including disciplinary action, grievances, complaints, salaries, and benefits.
- Any other information reasonably regarded as confidential.

03 Required practice

Staff must:

- Use approved systems and channels for student, family, and employee information.
- Keep paper and digital records secure and protect passwords and access.
- Discuss confidential matters in private, never where students, visitors, or unrelated staff can hear.
- Protect information in verbal, written, electronic, and social-media communication.
- Share the minimum information necessary for the task or decision.
- Report lost records, misdirected messages, unauthorised access, or accidental disclosure immediately.

04 Children and safeguarding

Do not promise a child that information will remain secret. Explain that information may need to be shared with a trusted safeguarding lead to keep someone safe. A safeguarding duty may require information to be reported even when it is otherwise confidential.

05 Prohibited use

Staff may not access information out of curiosity, use it for personal advantage, post it on personal social media, send it through unapproved accounts, or discuss it casually. School information may not be used to intimidate, embarrass, or undermine another person.

06 Breach and continuing duty

A breach of confidentiality constitutes serious misconduct and may result in disciplinary action, including dismissal after a fair process. The duty of confidentiality continues after employment ends. School records, devices, keys, and access credentials must be returned or disabled through the approved exit process.